

tapering plumes of tiny, coral-pink flowers are borne in summer above divided leaves; dry, brown flowers remain on plant well into winter. Z3–8

A. ‘Venus’ illus. p.234.

A. ‘Willie Buchanan’ (*simplicifolia* hybrid). Clump-forming perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), 5 8in (20cm). Has neat clumps of divided, red- or bronze-tinted, green leaves. Bears loose, conical sprays of tiny, star-shaped, pale pink flowers, with white petals, in mid- and late summer. Z4–8

ASTILBOIDES

SAXIFRAGACEAE

A genus of a single species of perennial grown for interesting foliage that turns reddish in fall, requiring a semishaded, moist, but well drained position. Propagate by division or seed sown in fall.

A. tabularis, syn. *Rodgersia tabularis*, illus. p.435.

ASTRANTIA

Masterwort

APIACEAE/UMBELLIFERAE

Genus of perennials, widely used in flower arrangements. Requires sun or semishade and well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed when fresh, in late summer.

A. ‘Hadspen Blood’. Clump-forming perennial. H to 3ft (90cm), 5 18in (45cm). In early and mid-summer, produces small, dark red flowers surrounded by dark red bracts above deeply lobed leaves. Z7–10

A. major. Clump-forming perennial. H 12–36in (30–90cm), 5 18in (45cm). Bears greenish-white, sometimes pink-tinged flower heads in summer–fall above a dense mass of divided, mid-green leaves. Z4–7.

subsp. carinthiaca see *A.m.* subsp. involucrata. **subsp. involucrata** (syn. *A.m.* subsp. *carinthiaca*) has pink-tinged flower heads with long bracts throughout summer. **subsp. involucrata ‘Margery Fish’** see *A.m.* subsp. *involucrata* ‘Shaggy’. **subsp. involucrata ‘Shaggy’** (syn. *A.m.* ‘Margery Fish’), has flower heads with very long bracts with prominent green tips, and deeply cut leaves. **subsp. involucrata ‘Sunningdale Variegated’** (syn. *A.m.* ‘Variegata’) has pale pink bracts and attractive leaves unevenly margined creamy yellow. **‘Ruby Wedding’** illus. p.238. **‘Variegata’** see *A.m.* subsp. *involucrata* ‘Sunningdale Variegated’. **‘Venice’** is vigorous, with deep pinkish-red flowers.

A. maxima illus. p.278.

A. ‘Roma’ illus. p.278.

ASTROPHYTUM

CACTACEAE

Genus of slow-growing, perennial cacti, grown for their freely produced, flattish, yellow flowers, some with red centers. Prefers sun and very well-drained,alkaline soil. Allow to dry out in winter. Prone to rot if wet. Propagate by seed sown in spring or summer.

A. asterias, syn. *Echinocactus asterias* (Sea urchin, Silver dollar cactus). Slow-growing, slightly domed, perennial cactus.

H 3–4in (8–10cm), 5 4in (10cm). Spineless stem has about 8 low ribs bearing small, tufted areoles. Produces bright yellow flowers, to 2½in (6cm) across, in summer. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

A. myriostigma, syn. *Echinocactus myriostigma* (Bishop’s cap), illus. p.494.

A. ornatum, syn. *Echinocactus ornatus*, illus. p.495.

Asystasia bella. See *Mackaya bella*.

ATHROTAXIS

CUPRESSACEAE

Genus of conifers with awl-shaped leaves that clasp stems. See also CONIFERS.

A. selaginoides (King William pine). Irregularly conical conifer. H 50–100ft (15–30m) or more, 5 12–25ft (4–8m). Has tiny, thick-textured, loosely overlapping, dark green leaves and insignificant, globular cones. Z8–9

ATHYRIUM

WOODSIACEAE/ATHYRIACEAE

Genus of deciduous ferns. Needs shade and humus-rich, moist soil. Remove fading fronds regularly. Propagate by spores in late summer or by division in fall or winter.

A. filix-femina (Lady fern). Deciduous fern. H 2–4ft (60cm–1.2m), 5 1–3ft (30cm–1m). Dainty, lance-shaped, much-divided, arching fronds are pale green. Has very variable frond dissection. Z4–9

A. ‘Ghost’ illus. p.290.

A. goeringianum. See *A. niponicum*.

A. niponicum, syn. *A. goeringianum*. **var. pictum ‘Burgundy Lace’** illus. p.290. **var. pictum ‘Silver Falls’** is a deciduous fern. H 20in (50cm), 5 16in (40cm). Has triangular, pale green fronds heavily suffused with silvery gray, and with dull pink midribs. Z6–10

A. nipponicum. See *A. niponicum*.

A. otophorum. Semievergreen fern. H and S to 30in (75cm). Has arching, broadly ovate, mid-green or purple-tinged, divided fronds, 18–30in (45–75cm) long. Stalk and midrib are a contrasting deep wine-purple. Z5–8. **var. okanum** differs from the species in its pinnae, with stalks ¼–½in (2–3mm) long, rather than nearly sessile. Z6–10

ATRIPLEX

AMARANTHACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials and evergreen or semievergreen shrubs and subshrubs, grown for their foliage. Grows well in coastal areas. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings taken in summer or by seed sown in fall.

A. halimus (Tree purslane). Semi-evergreen, bushy shrub. H 6ft (2m), 5 8ft (2.5m). Ovate leaves are silvery gray. Produces flowers very rarely. Z7–9

A. hortensis var. rubra (Red mountain spinach, Red orach). Fast-growing, erect annual. H 4ft (1.2m), 5 1ft (30cm). Triangular, deep red leaves, to 6in (15cm) long, are edible. Bears insignificant flowers in summer. Z7–9

AUBRIETA

BRASSICACEAE/CRUCIFERAE

Genus of evergreen, trailing and mound-forming perennials. Useful on dry banks, walls and in rock gardens. Thrives in a sunny position in any well-drained soil. To maintain a compact shape, cut back hard after flowering. Propagate by greenwood cuttings in summer or semiripe cuttings in late summer or fall.

A. ‘Carnival’. See *A. ‘Hartswood Purple’*.

A. x cultorum ‘Argenteovariegata’ illus. p.354.

A. ‘Doctor Mules’. Vigorous, mound-forming, evergreen perennial. H 2–3in (5–8cm), 5 12in (30cm). Has rounded, toothed, soft green leaves and bears short spikes of large, single, rich purple flowers in spring. Z5–7

A. ‘Doctor Mules Variegata’ illus. p.354.

A. gracilis ‘Kitte Rose’. Mat-forming perennial. H 2in (5cm), 5 to 2ft (60cm) or more. Has mid-green leaves and bears single, round, purple flowers with a white center in spring. Z5–9

A. ‘Greencourt Purple’ illus. p.354.

A. ‘Hartswood Purple’, syn. *A. ‘Carnival’*. Vigorous, evergreen, mound-forming perennial. H 4in (10cm), 5 12in (30cm). Has small, soft green leaves and produces many short spikes of large, single, violet-purple flowers in spring. Z5–7

A. ‘Joy’ illus. p.353.

A. ‘Purple Charm’ illus. p.355.

A. ‘Swan Red’. Mat-forming perennial. H 2in (5cm), 5 to 2ft (60cm) or more. Has white-margined, mid-green leaves, and narrow-petaled flowers in spring that open pink and age to dark magenta. Z5–9

AUCUBA

GARRYACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown for their foliage and fruits. To obtain fruits, grow both male and female plants. Tolerates full sun through to dense shade. Grow in any but water-logged soil. To restrict growth, cut old shoots back hard in spring. Propagate by semiripe cuttings taken in summer.

A. japonica. Evergreen, dense, bushy shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Has sturdy, green shoots and glossy, dark green leaves. Small, purplish flowers in midspring are followed on female plants by rounded to egg-shaped, bright red berries. Z6–10.

‘Crotonifolia’, H and S 6ft (2m), is female, with leaves heavily mottled yellow.

‘Golden King’, is female, with striking yellow-speckled leaves. **f. longifolia ‘Salicifolia’** is female, with slender, dark green leaves. **PEPPER POT (‘Shilpot’)**, 4ft (1.2m), is a compact, male form with glossy green, coarsely toothed leaves, heavily spotted with tiny, yellow dots. **‘Rozannie’**, H 3ft (1m), is compact, with broadly elliptic, dark green leaves and bisexual flowers.

AURINIA

BRASSICACEAE/CRUCIFERAE

Genus of biennials or evergreen perennials, grown for their gray-green foliage and showy flower sprays. Good for rock gardens, walls and banks. Needs sun

and well-drained soil. Propagate by soft- or greenwood cuttings in early summer or by seed in fall.

A. saxatilis, syn. *Alyssum saxatile* (Gold dust), illus. p.335. **‘Citrina’** illus. p.335.

‘Dudley Nevill’ is an evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 9in (23cm), 5 12in (30cm). Has ovate, hairy, gray-green leaves and, in late spring and early summer, racemes of many small, 4-petaled, buff-yellow flowers.

‘Variegata’ illus. p.335. Z4–8

AUSTROCEDRUS

CUPRESSACEAE

Genus of conifers with flattish sprays of scalelike leaves. See also CONIFERS.

A. chilensis, syn. *Libocedrus chilensis* (Chilean incense cedar), illus. p.100.

Avena candida. See *Helictotrichon sempervirens*.

Avena sempervirens. See *Helictotrichon sempervirens*.

AZARA

SALICACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and small trees, grown for their foliage and also for their yellow flowers, which comprise a mass of stamens. Where marginally hardy, plants are best grown against a south- or west-facing wall. Grows in sun or shade, and in fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

A. lanceolata. Evergreen, bushy shrub or spreading tree. H and S 15ft (5m). Has narrowly ovate, sharply toothed, bright green leaves. Has small, rounded clusters of pale yellow flowers in late spring or early summer. Z8–10

A. microphylla illus. p.118. **‘Variegata’** illus. p.119.

A. serrata illus. p.195.

AZORELLA

APIACEAE/UMBELLIFERAE

Genus of evergreen, tufted or spreading perennials, grown for their flowers and neat, rosetted foliage. Useful as an alpine houseplant. Thrives in full light and well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring.

A. nivalis. See *A. trifurcata*.

A. trifurcata, syn. *A. nivalis*, illus. p.376.

AZORINA

CAMPANULACEAE

Genus of one species of erect, evergreen shrub with bell-shaped flowers. Needs full light and fertile, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or by softwood or semiripe cuttings in summer.

A. vidalii, syn. *Campanula vidalii*, illus. p.453.

Azureocereus hertlingianus. See *Browningia hertlingiana*.